

WEEK 01

21 SEP - 27 SEP / LONDON

RUNNING	MON 21 SEP	TUE 22 SEP	WED 23 SEP	THU 24 SEP	FRI 25 SEP	SAT 26 SEP	SUN 27 SEP
ADJUSTED 68-70 km this week	Long ride 113.2 km cycling 5 h 09 min moving Already completed.	10 km Easy run Completed. Also 10 km hiking.	Rest Recovery day. No training.	10-12 km Easy run If legs feel normal. Rest if still heavy.	12 km Easy run Easy throughout. No fast finish.	6 km Recovery Very easy throughout. No strides.	30 km Progression 18 E + 5 steady + 5 G + 2 E Conditional: see focus.
SESSION	COMPLETED	COMPLETED	REST	EASY	EASY	RECOVERY	LONG + QUALITY
FOCUS	No T or catch-up mileage. Sun only after normal easy running: steady = 4:45-4:55; G = 4:13-4:14/km, only if still controlled at 23 km. If legs remain heavy, use 20-24 E instead.						

WEEK 02

28 SEP - 4 OCT / LONDON TO SEOUL

RUNNING	MON 28 SEP	TUE 29 SEP	WED 30 SEP	THU 1 OCT	FRI 2 OCT	SAT 3 OCT	SUN 4 OCT
TRAVEL 73-76 km this week	Rest No running or cycling.	14 km Threshold 3 E; 3 x 10 min T 2 min jog between E to 14 total + strength 15 min	12 km Easy run Conversational E effort.	22-25 km Medium-long All E. Keep the effort conversational.	10 km Easy run Morning only. Fly to Seoul later.	Rest Flight / land in Seoul. No run.	15 km Easy run Find your route. Easy throughout.
SESSION	REST	QUALITY	EASY	AEROBIC ENDURANCE	EASY	REST	EASY
FOCUS	Tue: 30 minutes T. Thu: 22-25 km all easy; 25 is optional, with no fast finish. Fly Fri 2 Oct (at most 10 km beforehand), land Sat 3 Oct (no run); Sun: 15 km route scouting.						

WEEK 03

5 OCT - 11 OCT / SEOUL

RUNNING	MON 5 OCT	TUE 6 OCT	WED 7 OCT	THU 8 OCT	FRI 9 OCT	SAT 10 OCT	SUN 11 OCT
BUILD 82 km weekly total	Rest No running or cycling.	14 km Threshold 3 E; 2 x 15 min T 2 min jog between E to 14 total + strength 20 min	12 km Easy run Conversational E effort.	18 km Medium-long All E. Keep the effort conversational. + strength 15 min	6 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	8 km Easy run Include 6 x 20 sec strides.	24 km Long + G 8 E + 4 G + 1 E + 4 G + 7 E G: 4:13-4:14/km
SESSION	REST	QUALITY	EASY	AEROBIC ENDURANCE	RECOVERY	EASY	LONG + QUALITY
FOCUS	Tue: 30 minutes T. Sun: 2 x 4 km G (4:13-4:14/km). Start below T effort; if G already feels like T, use current sustainable M effort and do not extend the blocks next week.						

PACE KEY E easy: 5:05-5:40/km | R recovery: 5:30-6:10/km or slower | T threshold: initially 4:15-4:20/km | I intervals: initially 3:58-4:05/km
Paces are guides in cool, flat conditions; effort takes priority. M = transitional marathon effort as printed; G = goal pace 4:13-4:14/km. Full key and G rules: page 4.

Daily totals include warm-up, recoveries, cool-down and strides. Keep 2 km easy after quality. Fly 2 Oct; land 3 Oct. No runs on 3 Oct or 31 Oct.

VALENCIA 2026

SUB-3 TRAINING PLAN

12 OCTOBER - 1 NOVEMBER

Race: Sunday 6 December 2026 / All distances in km

WEEK 04 12 OCT - 18 OCT / SEOUL

RUNNING	MON 12 OCT	TUE 13 OCT	WED 14 OCT	THU 15 OCT	FRI 16 OCT	SAT 17 OCT	SUN 18 OCT
SPECIFIC 85 km weekly total	Rest No running or cycling.	15 km Threshold 3 E; 3 x 10 min T 2 min jog between E to 15 total + strength 15 min	12 km Easy run Conversational E effort.	18 km Medium-long All E. Keep the effort conversational.	6 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	8 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	26 km Long + G 6 E; 3 x 4 km G 1 km steady between 6 E to finish
SESSION	REST	QUALITY	EASY	AEROBIC ENDURANCE	RECOVERY	RECOVERY	LONG + QUALITY
FOCUS	Tue T reduced to 30 minutes for the larger Sun session. Sun: 3 x 4 km G, with 1 km steady (4:45-4:55/km) between. Extend only after controlled 11 Oct; otherwise repeat 2 x 4.						

WEEK 05 19 OCT - 25 OCT / SEOUL

RUNNING	MON 19 OCT	TUE 20 OCT	WED 21 OCT	THU 22 OCT	FRI 23 OCT	SAT 24 OCT	SUN 25 OCT
BUILD 79 km weekly total	Rest No running or cycling.	18 km Medium-long All E. Keep the effort conversational.	12 km Easy run Conversational E effort.	15 km Threshold 3 E; 2 x 18 min T 2 min jog between E to 15 total + strength 15 min	8 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	26 km Long run All E. No fast finish. Cap: 2 h 30 elapsed. Practise race fuel.	Rest Hotel checkout. Hard hike tomorrow.
SESSION	REST	AEROBIC ENDURANCE	EASY	QUALITY	RECOVERY	LONG	REST
FOCUS	Thu: 36 minutes T in longer reps. Sat: 26 km easy or 2 h 30 elapsed, whichever comes first; no fast finish before Monday's hard hike. Sunday: checkout and rest.						

WEEK 06 26 OCT - 1 NOV / HIKING, SEOUL, THEN LONDON

RUNNING	MON 26 OCT	TUE 27 OCT	WED 28 OCT	THU 29 OCT	FRI 30 OCT	SAT 31 OCT	SUN 1 NOV
HIKE / FLY 52-58 km this week	Hard hike No run. Major training load.	Rest No running or cycling.	10 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	8 km Easy run Conversational E effort.	20-26 km Long + G 10 E + 12 G + 4 E Only if recovered; otherwise 20-26 E.	Rest Flight to London. No run.	14 km Easy run Easy throughout after travel.
SESSION	MAJOR LOAD	REST	RECOVERY	EASY	LONG + QUALITY	REST	EASY
FOCUS	No T this week. Fri: 26 km with 12 G only after controlled 18 Oct and normal Wed/Thu running after the hike. Otherwise 20-26 E or shorter/rest; cap 2 h 30 elapsed.						

OPTIONAL RACE; NO TEST REQUIRED

A race on 18 Oct replaces that day's workout: 10 km race = 3 E + race + 3 E; half = 2 E + race + 1 E. Count actual km. Use 2-3 easy/rest days afterwards, replacing Tue's medium-long. Omit Thu T unless recovered. Without a race, follow the scheduled G workout.

STRENGTH + FUEL

Strength: split squat, hip hinge, straight-knee and bent-knee calf raise; 2 sets each, 6-10 reps (calves 10-15). Use familiar loads, leave 2-3 reps in reserve. Use 1 set for a 10-minute session. Practise 60-90 g carbohydrate/hour on long runs; increase only as tolerated.

VALENCIA 2026

SUB-3 TRAINING PLAN

2 - 22 NOVEMBER

Race: Sunday 6 December 2026 / All distances in km

WEEK 07 2 NOV - 8 NOV / LONDON

RUNNING	MON 2 NOV	TUE 3 NOV	WED 4 NOV	THU 5 NOV	FRI 6 NOV	SAT 7 NOV	SUN 8 NOV
SPECIFIC 90 km weekly total	Rest No running or cycling.	14 km Threshold 3 E; 3 x 2 km T 0.5 km jog between 4 E to finish + strength 20 min	12 km Easy run Conversational E effort.	20 km Medium-long All E. Keep the effort conversational. + strength 15 min	6 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	8 km Easy run Include 4 x 20 sec strides.	30 km Goal-pace long 12 E + 16 G + 2 E G: 4:13-4:14/km Continuous G block.
SESSION	REST	QUALITY	EASY	AEROBIC ENDURANCE	RECOVERY	EASY	LONG + QUALITY
FOCUS	Sun: 16 continuous km G inside 30 km. Extend only after a controlled 12 G on 30 Oct. If that was missed or laboured, use 10-12 G or sustainable M effort; E to 30 total.						

WEEK 08 9 NOV - 15 NOV / LONDON

RUNNING	MON 9 NOV	TUE 10 NOV	WED 11 NOV	THU 12 NOV	FRI 13 NOV	SAT 14 NOV	SUN 15 NOV
PEAK 94-98 km this week	Rest No running or cycling.	12 km Easy run Conversational E effort. + strength 15 min	12-16 km Intervals AM 12: 4 x 3 min I 2 min jog; E to 12 PM 4 R optional	8 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	20 km Medium-long All E. Keep the effort conversational.	10 km Easy run Include 6 x 20 sec strides.	32 km Main rehearsal 10 E + 20 G + 2 E G: 4:13-4:14/km Race kit and fuel.
SESSION	REST	EASY	QUALITY	RECOVERY	AEROBIC ENDURANCE	EASY	LONG + QUALITY
FOCUS	94 km core; optional Wed PM 4 km, at least 6 hours after AM. Wed intervals shortened for Sun: 20 continuous km G inside 32 km, 21 days before Valencia. Extend only if 8 Nov was controlled.						

WEEK 09 16 NOV - 22 NOV / LONDON

RUNNING	MON 16 NOV	TUE 17 NOV	WED 18 NOV	THU 19 NOV	FRI 20 NOV	SAT 21 NOV	SUN 22 NOV
TAPER 1 72 km weekly total	Rest No running or cycling.	10 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	12 km Easy run Conversational E effort.	12 km Threshold 3 E; 2 x 8 min T 2 min jog between E to 12 total + strength 10 min	6 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	8 km Easy run Include 4 x 20 sec strides.	24 km Long + G 14 E + 8 G + 2 E Practise breakfast, kit and fuel.
SESSION	REST	RECOVERY	EASY	QUALITY	RECOVERY	EASY	LONG + QUALITY
FOCUS	Reduce volume after the main rehearsal; Thu has just 16 minutes T. Sun: 8 km at your confirmed race pace inside 24 km, controlled throughout. Use G only if 15 Nov supports it.						

15 NOVEMBER: THE MAIN REHEARSAL

Encouraging evidence: 20 km at G without extra recovery stops or marked late fade, starting clearly below T effort and remaining controlled. Use race kit and practised fuel. Normal easy running within 48 hours adds evidence; this workout cannot guarantee sub-3.

IF THE WORK IS NOT BEING ABSORBED

If G feels like T early, slow to sustainable M effort or finish easy. After a laboured/missed 16 G, cap the next block at the last controlled dose; do not force 20 G or repeat a test in the taper. Drop Wed PM first; replace quality with E/rest if not recovered.

VALENCIA 2026

SUB-3 TRAINING PLAN

23 NOVEMBER - 6 DECEMBER

Race: Sunday 6 December 2026 / All distances in km

WEEK 10 23 NOV - 29 NOV / LONDON

RUNNING	MON 23 NOV	TUE 24 NOV	WED 25 NOV	THU 26 NOV	FRI 27 NOV	SAT 28 NOV	SUN 29 NOV
TAPER 2 54 km weekly total	Rest No running or cycling.	10 km Intervals 3 E; 4 x 2 min I 2 min jog between E to 10 total + strength 10 min	8 km Easy run Conversational E effort.	10 km Race pace 3 E + 5 G + 2 E Comfortably controlled.	4 km Recovery Relaxed R effort.	4 km Easy run Include 4 x 20 sec strides.	18 km Long run All E. Finish feeling you could do more.
SESSION	REST	QUALITY	EASY	QUALITY	RECOVERY	EASY	LONG
FOCUS	Keep the fast running relaxed and brief. No extra distance, hard cycling or catch-up sessions. This is the final week with a small strength maintenance session.						

WEEK 11 30 NOV - 6 DEC / VALENCIA

RUNNING	MON 30 NOV	TUE 1 DEC	WED 2 DEC	THU 3 DEC	FRI 4 DEC	SAT 5 DEC	SUN 6 DEC
RACE 28 km before race 70.2 km total	Rest No running or cycling.	8 km Easy run Include 4 x 20 sec strides.	8 km Dress rehearsal 3 E + 3 G + 2 E Use race shoes.	6 km Easy run Conversational E effort.	3 km Recovery Brief shakeout.	3 km Easy run Include 3 x 15 sec strides.	VALENCIA 42.195 km Sub-3 target Goal: 4:13-4:14/km
SESSION	REST	EASY	QUALITY	EASY	RECOVERY	EASY	RACE
FOCUS	28 km before race day; 70.2 km including the marathon. Use only practised food, fuel and kit. Keep sightseeing light. Distances can shorten for Valencia travel.						

PACES AND SESSION RULES

E / medium-long: 5:05-5:40/km to start; full-sentence conversation, about 2-4/10 effort. Let pace improve naturally.

R: 5:30-6:10/km or slower; about 2-3/10 effort.

T: comfortably hard, about 6-7/10. Start around 4:15-4:20/km, slower if needed. Improve pace only when work stays controlled; increase duration before chasing faster splits.

I: current 5 km effort, about 8/10. Start 3:58-4:05/km; keep reps even. Adjust as repeatable training improves, rather than chasing the calendar.

M / G: M is current sustainable marathon effort. G is the 4:13-4:14/km target. These larger G doses must start below T effort. If not, use current M effort; extend distance only after the previous dose stays controlled.

Strides: fast and relaxed, never a sprint; 60-90 sec easy jog between. Recoveries are between reps only. Warm up for 3 km before T/I.

RACE EXECUTION AND ADJUSTMENTS

Race pace: if the rehearsals support sub-3, open the first 3 km at 4:17-4:20/km, then settle at 4:13-4:14/km. Aim for halfway around 1:29:15-1:29:40 using official distance markers; GPS pace is a guide.

Fuel: use the breakfast and carbohydrate intake you practised. Build towards 75-90 g/hour for race day if tolerated; count drinks as well as gels. Drink according to thirst and your practised needs.

Progression: advance volume only after normal recovery from the previous comparable week. If not recovered, hold that volume by trimming easy runs and remove the next fast block. Stop if pain changes your stride.

Extra activity: the schedule includes the training load intended. Easy cycling can replace a recovery run; a hard ride or strenuous hike replaces a hard/long session. Keep rest days free.

Totals: running only. Ranges show optional distance, not minimums. A shortened run lowers the total. Do not make up missed sessions; keep 48 hours between demanding workouts.

Basis: supplied Runalyze export through 21 Sep; Pfitzinger 18/55 photos; Ben Parkes L5 PDF. Exact sessions and checkpoints are individual programming judgments.
[Training volume / intensity](#) [Long-run evidence](#) [Threshold guidance](#) [Taper research](#) [Strength research](#) [Nutrition guidance](#)